Seranai

OpenFOS

Open Founder Operating System

Go-to-Market-Strategy

24 Skills + 2 Reference Modules
Organized by FOUNDRY Framework

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What Is This Skill?

The GTM Motion Selector is an AI-powered tool that helps you answer one of the most consequential decisions any early-stage founder faces: how do you actually reach and convert your first customers?

There are three proven go-to-market motions and picking the wrong one is one of the most common and expensive mistakes founders make. A product that should be sold through enterprise sales doesn't go viral. A tool that could spread itself through a viral loop doesn't need a sales team. Content that should be educating buyers sits unread because the wrong channel was chosen.

This skill diagnoses your situation and tells you which motion fits not generically, but specifically to your product, your buyer, and your stage.

THE THREE GTM MOTIONS

Product-Led Growth (PLG): The product acquires users by being used. Every interaction exposes it to new potential customers. Examples: Slack, Calendly.

Sales-Led Growth (SLG): A dedicated sales team closes deals. High-value enterprise buyers are identified, engaged, and guided to a decision. Examples: Salesforce, Veeva Systems.

Content-Led Growth (CLG): Educational content attracts buyers organically through search and social. Trust is built before a sale is ever made. Examples: HubSpot, Ahrefs.

It works as a conversation. You describe your product and your customer and the skill diagnoses which motion fits, scores all three options, shows you comparable companies, and delivers a 30-day execution plan. No frameworks to memorise, no templates to fill out.

THE CORE PRINCIPLE

GTM motion must follow customer type - not founder comfort.

The skill never recommends what sounds exciting. It recommends what fits.

Who Is This For?

This skill is designed for founders who have identified their target customer and are now deciding how to reach and convert them. It is especially useful if:

- You've validated your problem and defined your buyer persona, and you're now deciding how to acquire your first 10, 100, or 1,000 customers
- You have a product and some early users, but growth feels random - you want a deliberate channel strategy
- You're preparing to hire your first sales or marketing person and need to know which motion to staff for
- You're a B2B founder choosing between enterprise sales and a self-serve product model
- You're a solo or first-time founder who has never built a go-to-market engine before
- You have a strong product but no clear answer to the question: "where do customers come from?"

This skill works for founders across industries and geographies. Whether you are selling to enterprises in Singapore, SMBs in Lagos, or developers in Berlin - the diagnostic adapts to your buyer type and market context.

How to Get Started

Using this skill requires three things: access to Claude (claude.ai or the Claude app), the GTM Motion Selector skill installed, and your idea described in your own words.

Step 1: Open Claude and Start a New Conversation

Go to claude.ai or open the Claude app. Start a new conversation. That's it.

Step 2: Describe Your Startup and Your Customer

Tell Claude what your product does, who your customer is, and how you've been thinking about reaching them. You don't need a polished answer, rough thinking is explicitly welcomed. The skill will ask follow-up questions for anything that's missing.

Examples of Great Starting Messages:

EXAMPLE 1 — Detailed
"I'm building a compliance monitoring tool for fintech startups in Southeast Asia. My buyers are CTOs and compliance leads at Series A fintechs. I'm thinking of charging $800/month. I'm not sure whether to hire a salesperson or try to make the product self-serve."

EXAMPLE 2 — Brief
"Invoice management SaaS for freelance designers in India. Pricing around ₹1,500/month. I'm thinking content marketing but I'm not sure."

EXAMPLE 3 — Minimal
"Inventory management for small grocery stores in Nigeria."

All three will work. The more detail you provide, the faster you'll reach your first recommendation. But even a single sentence is enough - the skill will ask only for what's genuinely missing.

Step 3: Follow the Conversation

The skill guides you through four phases. You don't need to prepare anything in advance or remember any steps. Just respond naturally to the questions it asks. The whole process takes about 20 minutes.

What Happens: The Four Phases

The skill walks you through four phases, each building on the last. Here's what to expect at each stage.

PHASE 1: INSTANT GTM DIAGNOSIS *Your motion fit scored across all three channels • ~3 minutes*	
What You Do	• Describe your product in one sentence • Name your target customer and their buying process • Share any GTM thinking you already have (even if rough)
What You Get	• **A GTM Motion Fit Matrix**: all three motions scored 1-10 with a rationale for each score specific to your product and buyer • **A Preliminary Motion Verdict**: which motion the skill is recommending, and why, with a comparable company example • **A Motion Tension Flag:** the core tension in your GTM decision (e.g. product could support PLG but buyer complexity suggests SLG)

WHY THIS MATTERS:

The skill never asks for information you've already provided. If your price point, customer type, or product mechanics appear anywhere in your message, they are carried forward without asking again. This keeps the process fast and specific to you.

PHASE 2: STRATEGIC SHARPENING *Pressure-testing the diagnosis with targeted questions • ~5 minutes*	
What You Do	• Answer 4- 6 questions about your product virality, buyer complexity, content demand, ACV, and team capacity • You don't need exact numbers - rough estimates are enough
What You Get	• **Deeper understanding of your GTM fit** - the skill refines its diagnosis based on your answers, particularly around ACV and buyer process • **Red flags surfaced early** - if your assumptions conflict with the recommended motion, they are flagged here before you commit

PHASE 3: FULL SCORECARD + RECOMMENDATION *All three motions scored, compared, and decided • ~7 minutes to read*	
What You Do	• Review the full scorecard across five dimensions • Read the comparable company analysis • Consider the bear case before accepting the recommendation

What You Get	• **Full GTM Motion Scorecard** - five dimensions scored for all three motions: Product Virality, Buyer Complexity, ACV Fit, Content Demand, and Founder Capacity • **Comparable Company Analysis:** 2- 3 real companies that faced a similar decision, what they chose, and what the founder can learn • **Bear Case:** the 3 specific risks that would make the recommended motion fail. This section is mandatory. • **Final Verdict** : a clear motion recommendation (or a sequenced hybrid), a positioning statement, and the single biggest risk to mitigate

PHASE 4: GTM EXECUTION PLAN + 30-DAY SPRINT *Your channel tactics and week-by-week launch plan • ~5 minutes to read*	
What You Do	• Review the channel tactics for your recommended motion • Confirm the 30-day sprint plan and adjust for your team size • Note the five confirmation and five pivot signals
What You Get	• **Motion-specific channel tactics:** detailed playbook for PLG (viral loop design), SLG (ICP + outbound sequence), or CLG (content pillars + SEO) • **30-Day GTM Sprint:** a week-by-week action plan covering foundation, first contact, iteration, and the decision to double down or pivot • **5 Confirmation Signals + 5 Pivot Signals:** specific to your situation so you know exactly what 'working' and 'not working' look like • **Bridge to the next skill**: a clear handoff based on which motion you've selected

Understanding Your Results

The Three GTM Motions — and When Each One Works

Most founders intuitively understand what sales and marketing are. What they miss is that each motion has a specific customer profile and product type it works for and using the wrong one is not just inefficient, it actively prevents growth.

PLG — Product-Led Growth	SLG — Sales-Led Growth	CLG — Content-Led Growth
The product acquires users by being used. Every use creates exposure to a new potential user.	A dedicated sales team identifies buyers, runs demos, and guides deals to close.	Educational content attracts buyers organically through search, YouTube, and social.
Best for: Products with network effects or natural sharing. Low ACV, self-serve buyers.	**Best for:** Enterprise or mid-market B2B. High ACV,	**Best for:** Products solving problems buyers actively search

	multi-stakeholder decisions, complex buying process.	for. Mid-range ACV, buyers who learn before they buy.
Slack, Calendly, Dropbox, Zoom	Salesforce, Veeva Systems, Palantir, Workday	HubSpot, Ahrefs, Intercom, Moz
Fails when: There's no viral loop. The product only makes sense for one user.	**Fails when:** ACV is too low to justify CAC. Buyer is self-serve. Sales cycle kills runway.	**Fails when:** Buyers don't search for the solution. Content takes 12+ months to compound.

The Five Scoring Dimensions

The skill scores all three motions across five dimensions. Here is what each dimension measures and why it matters.

Dimension	What It Measures	Why It Matters
Product Virality	Does using the product expose it to new potential users? Is there a natural sharing moment?	Without virality, PLG is just a free trial. With it, CAC approaches zero.
Buyer Complexity	How many people are involved in the buying decision? Is there a procurement process?	High complexity requires SLG. Low complexity enables PLG or CLG.
ACV Fit	Does the annual contract value justify the cost of acquisition for each motion?	SLG needs high ACV (>$15K) to justify a sales team. PLG needs low ACV (<$5K) to self-serve.
Content Demand	Are buyers actively searching for solutions to this problem online? Is there search volume?	CLG only works if buyers are Googling. No search intent means no organic channel.
Founder Capacity	Does the founder's team have the skills and resources for the recommended motion?	A solo technical founder can't run enterprise sales. A team with no writers can't do CLG.

Reading the Verdict

After the full scorecard, the skill issues one of three verdicts:

Verdict	What It Means	What to Do
🎯 **CLEAR MOTION**	One motion scores 10+ points higher than the next best, and the bear case is manageable.	Commit to this motion for 12 months. Run the 30-day sprint immediately.
⚖️ **HYBRID STRATEGY**	Two motions are within 5 points of each other. Both could work.	Pick a primary motion for Year 1 and a secondary for Year 2. Do not run both simultaneously.
🔄 **REFRAME NEEDED**	No motion scores above 30/50. The product-channel fit doesn't exist yet.	Revisit your value proposition or buyer definition. GTM motion can't be chosen until the buyer is sharper.

The Bear Case - Why This Section Is Mandatory

Every recommendation in this skill includes a bear case: the three specific conditions that would cause the recommended motion to fail. This section is not optional.

Founders who skip the bear case and commit to a motion they haven't stress-tested are among the most common case studies in GTM failure. The skill is designed to make sure that never happens to you.

Read the bear case carefully. If any of the three risks apply to your specific situation, address them in your execution plan before you start.

Tips for Getting the Most Out of This Skill

Be honest about your ACV. Nothing determines GTM motion more than price point. A $500/year product cannot support a sales team. A $50,000/year product rarely goes self-serve. If you don't know your price yet, give a range - the skill will work with it.

Describe the buying process, not just the product. The single most important input is: who signs the contract, and what do they need before they sign it? A founder who knows their buyer's process gets a far more specific diagnosis than one who only describes their features.

"I don't know" moves you forward. If you don't know your close rate, viral coefficient, or search volume, say so. The skill will suggest reasonable benchmarks, show you where to find real data, and ask if the estimate sounds right. Uncertainty is data - it tells you what to research next.

Don't choose based on what sounds exciting. PLG sounds exciting. Viral growth is a compelling story. But most B2B products don't have a viral loop - they have a free trial. The skill will tell you if your product actually qualifies for PLG or if you're using the label to avoid building a sales motion.

Run it for each motion you're considering. If you're genuinely torn between PLG and SLG, ask the skill to stress-test both. The contrast between the two scorecards is often more revealing than any single recommendation.

Use the 30-day sprint, not just the recommendation. The recommendation tells you which motion to use. The sprint tells you what to do on Monday morning. Don't stop at the diagnosis, the value is in the execution plan.

Come back when your assumptions change. GTM motion is not a one-time decision. As you talk to customers and close your first deals, you'll learn things that change the diagnosis. Rerun the skill with updated inputs every quarter in Year 1.

Frequently Asked Questions

Do I need to have done the earlier skills first?

Not strictly. The skill works with whatever you bring. But founders who have done Persona Definition (Skill 4) and Value Proposition Design (Skill 5) get significantly sharper output because knowing exactly who your buyer is and why they'd buy is the input that determines which motion fits.

What if my product could work with more than one motion?

Many products could theoretically support two motions. The skill will tell you this and present a hybrid strategy with a clear primary motion for Year 1. Splitting focus between two motions from day one is almost always a mistake, each motion requires different skills, tooling, and metrics. Pick one primary motion first.

What if I already have a GTM motion in mind?

Tell the skill what you're already doing. It will stress-test your assumption, score your current approach against the alternatives, and either confirm your instinct with data or show you the specific evidence that should give you pause. Founders with strong GTM convictions benefit most from seeing the bear case against their own approach.

My product is early-stage and I don't have many customers yet. Is this skill useful?

Yes, this is exactly the right time to use it. Choosing the wrong GTM motion before you have customers means you burn months going down the wrong channel. The skill is specifically designed to help you make this decision before committing budget and headcount.

What if I'm a solo founder with no sales or marketing experience?

The skill accounts for founder capacity as one of the five scoring dimensions. It will tell you which motion is feasible for your team size and flag if the recommended motion requires a hire or a skill you don't yet have. The 30-day sprint is designed to be executable by a solo founder.

Can I use this for a B2C product?

The skill is optimised for B2B, where buyer type, ACV, and procurement process drive the decision. For B2C products, the PLG diagnostic still applies (viral loops, network effects, self-serve), but the SLG dimension is largely not relevant. Tell Claude your product is B2C at the start and the skill will adjust accordingly.

What if no motion scores well?

A "Reframe Needed" verdict means no motion fits your current product-buyer configuration. This usually indicates one of three things: your value proposition isn't clear enough yet, your target buyer is too broadly defined, or the product doesn't have a repeatable acquisition mechanism yet. The skill will tell you which applies and what to fix.

How long does it take?

About 20 minutes for the full diagnosis, scorecard, and execution plan. Faster if you already know your ACV and buyer process. Longer if you want to explore a hybrid strategy or stress-test two motions side by side.

Is my data private?

Your conversation is between you and Claude. The skill does not store or share your business details with anyone.

The FOUNDRY Framework

FOUNDRY is the sequential journey framework that guides founders from initial idea through scale or exit. Each letter represents a stage, and each stage contains specific skills a founder needs to master.

Stage	Purpose	Skills
F – Foundation	Validate the idea. Confirm the problem is real, the market exists, and you know who to serve.	Skills 1–4
O – Outline	Design the business. Articulate value, map competition, model revenue, scope the MVP.	Skills 5–8
U – User	Acquire and understand customers. Discover needs, design GTM, set pricing, run experiments.	Skills 9–12
N – Nurture	Build relationships and traction. Craft the pitch, model financials, build the founder narrative.	Skills 13–15
D – Discipline	Execute and operate. Set OKRs, hire the team, handle legal and entity setup.	Skills 16–18
R – Results	Measure and iterate. Track KPIs, assess PMF, decide whether to pivot or persevere.	Skills 19–20
Y – Yield	Scale or exit. Confirm scaling readiness, plan liquidity events.	Skills 21–22

Cross-cutting skills (23–24) are not stage-specific and can be invoked at any point in the journey.

Reference modules (R1–R2) are shared evaluation lenses that multiple skills invoke. They are never used in isolation.

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